

MORRIS SIEGEL



Department of Many Things . . .

TAX LAWYER LEO DeORSEY, the new Nats director who raised a coast-to-coast fury with his pronouncements on baseball, may sound as if he were chairman of the board but he owns only five shares of stock in the ball club. . . . And whatever happened to Floyd Patterson? . . . Remember Tony Baker, the young left-handed protege of Nick Altrock who mimicked the venerable Nats clown at Griffith Stadium several years ago? Well, Tony is grown up now and recently signed as a pitcher in the Red Sox farm system. . . .

And whoever thought there would come a season when Notre Dame would be remembered for basketball, not football? . . . Many area golf pros who once charged \$3 for a 30-minute lesson have now upped their rates to \$3.50. . . . Owners of the Rosecroft and Baltimore trot tracks are still trying to persuade the Laurel harness oval to go along with them in a projected move to the Laurel Race Course and hold one 90-day meeting instead of three separate 30-day meets. . . .

District housewives are applauding the efforts of Senators Morse and Javits, who are trying to remove the sales tax from grocery purchases but the two solons and their fellow senators would really see their popularity in the District zoom if they took as much interest in trying to get Washington a first-rate sports stadium. . . . Former Nats outfielder Taft Wright is the co-owner of one of Orlando's most popular taverns. . . . When the Chicago Cubs peddled their Los Angeles franchise to the Dodgers for Brooklyn's Ft. Worth property the Cubs picked up \$2,000,000 cash in the deal. . . .

RADIOLAND'S LATEST ROMANCE is a sizzling affair between Bob Wolff and his new Nats sidekick, Chuck Thompson. Or so it seemed the other night when Wolff interrupted a commercial to coo sweet things about Thompson's first Nats broadcast. Chuck's telephoned response was sort of schmaltzy too. . . . Pro Mel Shorey & Co., of Indian Spring, are all excited about the club's formal move to its dazzling Wheaton layout, scheduled for April 1. . . . In the current issue of Saturday Evening Post, coach Red Auerbach credits the success of his champion Boston Celtics basketball team to two things: (1) The acquisition of Bill Russell and (2) Philadelphia's loss of Tom Gola to the Army. . . .

If rookie Marv Throneberry cuts the mustard and becomes the Yankees' first baseman he'll set an American League strikeout record, according to Nats infielder Tony Roig who watched Throneberry last year when both were in the American Association. . . . Until the IBC monopoly case is settled, fight announcers may be heard saying, "This fight is being brought to you by the International Boxing Club and the Justice Department." . . . Rocky Marciano is busy rehearsing "Stand Up and Fight," from Carmen, which he may use as this theme when he and Jimmy Durante team up for their night club act. . . .

A number of Californians, appreciative of his efforts to bring major league baseball to Los Angeles, are suggesting the projected \$9,000,000 LA ballpark be named Vincent Flaherty Field in honor of the Washington-born columnist for the LA Examiner. Flaherty is not opposed to the idea. . . . Catcher Clint Courtney's eight-horse stable is expected to be increased to 11 next month. Three of his mares are in foal. . . . Remember Andy Cohen, the infielder John McGraw brought to New York when he was convinced a Jewish player would be a fabulous attraction at the Polo Grounds? He's now managing Indianapolis of the American Association. . . . At the height of Cohen's popularity (1928) the Daily Forward, a Jewish language newspaper in New York, printed box scores of the Giants game. Once, when the Giants had an open date, the Forward's editors were baffled. They printed a small story at the bottom of page one which said: "There was no game at the Polo Grounds today; Andy Cohen must be sick." . . .